

The Streisand Effect

For those of you who don't know what the Streisand Effect is, the gist of it is the harder you try to hide something or make it go away, the more you're going to start drawing attention to it. The effect is named after Barbara Streisand, the famous American actress and singer who went to court to have certain photographs taken down. However, the court case drew media attention, which in turn ended up drawing even more attention to the photographs. Which bears the question, if she hadn't raised a fuss about it, would people still have remembered the photographs? The effect would most certainly have a different name, that's for sure.

If you're a long time SKOAR! reader, then you've probably already come across the Streisand Effect in one of our previous cover stories. Namely, games that became popular because they were actively being "shunned" or "boycotted" for whatever reason. For instance, back when Mortal Kombat first came out, hoo boy, the media were having a field day. "This is the stuff kids are exposed to in video games!", "My son plays this and I'm pretty sure he wants to rip people's spines out now!", you get the idea. These kind of comments were all over the place. All it did, though, was make Mortal Kombat the most popular game of its time. In essence, Mortal Kombat can probably thank the "bad" press for its overall success as a franchise today. I guess it is true, no such thing as bad publicity.

The reason I'm bringing up the Streisand Effect and Mortal Kombat right now is because we're witnessing

something similar with Hogwarts Legacy. As we know, anything associated with the Harry Potter franchise right now is a controversial topic, what with JK Rowling's current standing on social media platforms. Naturally, there have since been many calls to boycott Hogwarts Legacy – and anything to do with JK Rowling really. The idea being that she doesn't deserve a penny coming her way. From the looks of things though, it doesn't really look like Hogwarts Legacy is going to suffer from any of the boycott JK Rowling movements. It had 500,000 peak players on Steam two days before its official release. That's 500,000 pre-orders by the way. So if anything, the controversies have probably drawn more attention to both, the game and the Harry Potter franchise.

From what I've seen so far, Hogwarts Legacy is actually a pretty good game (review coming soon™). And I would also like to point out that a lot more people than JK Rowling have worked on this game. Heck, according to WB, her contribution was pretty minimal. I can't really claim how close to true that is, but regardless. If I'm spending money on this game, it's because I think the game developers - who have absolutely no fault in whatever is going on with JK Rowling - deserve my money. Sure, if she's to blame, don't give her money specifically, but I don't know how the legalities of that solution would work. Feel free to reach out and let me know if you've got any solutions. *



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